

EU Digital Services Act: AWS Transparency Report

For the reporting period covering February 17 – December 31, 2024

1. Introduction

In accordance with the requirements of Article 15 of the European Union (EU) Digital Services Act (DSA), Amazon Web Services (AWS) provides the following transparency report for the period of February 17 – December 31, 2024 (Reporting Period) regarding AWS services provided to customers in the EU. AWS is a cloud services provider that provides the underlying technology infrastructure (e.g., compute, storage, network) that makes it possible for our customers – including small startups, large enterprises, non-profit organizations, and government agencies – to build and operate their applications and services in the cloud.

2. Orders from EU Member State Authorities

During the Reporting Period, AWS received 1 binding order from an EU Member State authority to act against illegal content (as defined in the DSA), categorized below by the Member State issuing the order and the type of illegal content concerned. The median time needed to confirm receipt of the order was 0 hours. The median time for AWS to act against the content in response to the order was 1 hour.

Issuing EU Member State	Number of Orders
Austria	0
Belgium	0
Bulgaria	0
Croatia	0
Cyprus	0
Czechia	0
Denmark	0
Estonia	0
Finland	0
France	0
Germany	1
Greece	0
Hungary	0
Ireland	0
Italy	0
Latvia	0
Lithuania	0
Luxembourg	0
Malta	0
Netherlands	0
Poland	0
Portugal	0
Romania	0
Slovakia	0
Slovenia	0
Spain	0
Sweden	0

Type of Illegal Content	Number of Orders
Intellectual Property Infringement	0
Email Spam	0
Child Sexual Abuse Material	0
Malware Website	0
Phishing	0
Data Protection and Privacy Violation	0
Spam Website	0
Terrorist Content	1
Violence	0
Hate Speech	0
Image-based Sexual Abuse	0
Fraudulent Activity	0
Illegal Gambling	0
Other	0

During the Reporting Period, AWS also received 307 binding orders from EU Member State authorities to provide specific information about AWS customers, categorized below by the Member State issuing the order and the type of illegal content (as defined in the DSA) concerned. The median time needed to confirm receipt of an order was 0 hours due to automated acknowledgement notices. Where the reported content was hosted on AWS, the median time for AWS to provide information in response to an order was 7 calendar days.

Issuing EU Member State	Number of Orders
Austria	2
Belgium	1
Bulgaria	0
Croatia	0
Cyprus	0
Czechia	0
Denmark	0
Estonia	0
Finland	0
France	45
Germany	183
Greece	0
Hungary	0
Ireland	1
Italy	12
Latvia	0
Lithuania	0
Luxembourg	1
Malta	0
Netherlands	16
Poland	28

Issuing EU Member State	Number of Orders
Portugal	0
Romania	0
Slovakia	0
Slovenia	0
Spain	16
Sweden	2

Type of Illegal Content	Number of Orders
Intellectual Property Infringement	5
Email Spam	0
Child Sexual Abuse Material	3
Malware Website	0
Phishing	18
Data Protection and Privacy Violation	3
Spam Website	0
Terrorist Content	0
Violence	0
Hate Speech	1
Image-based Sexual Abuse	0
Fraudulent Activity	167
Illegal Gambling	0
Other	110

3. Article 16 Notices

During the Reporting Period, AWS received 34,052 notices of alleged illegal content (as defined in the DSA) via AWS's abuse reporting mechanism, categorized below by the type of alleged illegal content concerned.

Type of Alleged Illegal Content	Number of Notices Received
Intellectual Property Infringement	5,063
Email Spam	2,022
Child Sexual Abuse Material	39
Malware Website	374
Phishing	21,427
Data Protection and Privacy Violation	80
Spam Website	837
Terrorist Content	0
Violence	23
Hate Speech	5
Image-based Sexual Abuse	10
Fraudulent Activity	3,118
Illegal Gambling	126
Other	928

The above notices include informal and non-binding removal requests from government authorities. None of the above notices were submitted by trusted flaggers (as defined in the DSA). Most of these notices were resolved by our customers taking appropriate action to address the reported content. As a result, of the notices where the reported content was hosted on AWS, AWS took action to disable prohibited content for 1,556 notices pursuant to our terms of service, which prohibit the use of AWS services for any illegal activity (among other things). AWS did not make any decisions to disable prohibited content using automated means. The median time needed for AWS to take action to disable prohibited content was 46 hours.

4. AWS's Trust & Safety Practices and Mechanisms

AWS provides customers, partners, government authorities, and the general public a reporting mechanism administered by the AWS Trust & Safety (T&S) team to notify AWS of any alleged violations of AWS's terms of service, including any suspected illegal content. When T&S receives such a report and the reported content is hosted on AWS, T&S works with our customer so that our customer can address the report directly. Given the nature of cloud computing, our customers decide how to technically architect their use of our services and are, therefore, best positioned to take targeted action to address any prohibited content. In the event a customer does not appropriately address prohibited content, AWS may take action to address it directly. If a customer or an abuse reporter disagrees with any action AWS takes, we work with the relevant parties to resolve the matter.

T&S undergoes training on AWS's policies, internal guidelines, and processes before they handle any abuse cases. They also participate in regular calibration exercises and knowledge tests and receive ongoing wellness and resiliency resources. A robust quality assurance mechanism evaluates case handling to ensure consistent and accurate enforcement of our policies and internal guidelines.

Our customers are responsible for the applications and services as well as the content they and their end users choose to store on AWS, including ensuring compliance with AWS's terms of service and all applicable laws. As a cloud services provider, AWS does not access our customers' or their end users' content or engage in proactive content moderation, except in the following limited circumstances.

Consistent with industry practice and as described to our customers in AWS's terms of service, Amazon Simple Email Service (SES) and Amazon WorkMail have certain automated mechanisms in place that detect spam, phishing, and similar content being sent or received using these AWS services. If these mechanisms detect these types of content, T&S may manually review the content and, if the content violates AWS's terms of service, T&S may suspend use of these services. During the Reporting Period, AWS detected and restricted content that violates AWS's terms of service for SES and WorkMail as set out below.

Content Type	Number of Restrictions
Spam	507
Phishing	39
Fraudulent Activity	97

AWS is committed to the responsible use of artificial intelligence (AI). Amazon Bedrock is a fully managed AWS service that offers a choice of high-performing foundation models from leading AI companies through a single Application Programming Interface, along with a broad set of capabilities that customers can use to build generative AI applications. To help stop the dissemination of child sexual abuse material (CSAM), Amazon Bedrock implements an automated abuse detection mechanism that uses hash matching technology to detect apparent CSAM. If Amazon Bedrock detects apparent CSAM in a customer's image inputs, Amazon Bedrock automatically blocks the request and sends the customer an automated error message. AWS also files a report with the U.S.'s National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC). During the Reporting Period, Amazon Bedrock's automated CSAM detection mechanism detected and blocked 3 instances of apparent CSAM, which is a violation of AWS's terms of service. This automated mechanism has been assessed at a ~99.9% accuracy rate with hashes matched against NCMEC's verified CSAM database. Customers with questions about any action taken by Amazon Bedrock can reach out to T&S for resolution.